



WHERE SMALL MONEY BUILDS BIG FUTURES.

A PRACTICAL GHANAIAN WEALTH GUIDE

SMALL CEDIS, BIG WEALTH

*How Ordinary Ghanaians Can Build Real Wealth
Starting With GH¢1*

Robert Loh Kobla

Founder, Robayer WealthLab
www.robayerwealthlab.com

Copyright & Disclaimer

© 2026 Robayer WealthLab. All rights reserved.

No part of this publication may be reproduced, distributed, or transmitted in any form without prior written permission from the publisher, except for brief quotations used in reviews or non-commercial commentary.

This book is an educational guide. It is not financial, legal, or tax advice, and neither the author nor Robayer WealthLab is a licensed investment advisor. Every investment carries risk, including the risk of losing money, and no legitimate investment can guarantee a specific return, including any figures shown in this book.

All interest rates, fees, and minimum investment amounts in this book reflect information available as of mid-2026 and change regularly. Always confirm current rates directly with the institution before investing.

The growth tables and story examples in this book are illustrative projections, not promises. Real returns vary, and market-linked products such as stocks and mutual funds can also lose value in a given year.

Published by
Robayer WealthLab Press
Accra, Ghana

About Robayer WealthLab

Robayer WealthLab is a financial education company dedicated to helping Africans build wealth through practical knowledge, smart investing, entrepreneurship, and financial literacy.

Our mission is simple: to help ordinary people make extraordinary financial decisions.

We believe that financial education in Ghana should be practical, honest, and accessible to everyone, whether you're starting with GH¢1 or GH¢100,000. Every guide we publish is built on the same principle: real numbers, real platforms, and real warnings about what to avoid.

Visit www.robayerwealthlab.com

About the Author

Robert Loh Kobla is the Founder of Robayer WealthLab, a financial education platform committed to helping Africans build lasting wealth through practical financial education, disciplined investing, entrepreneurship, and informed decision-making.

Robert holds a Bachelor of Science (BSc) in Laboratory Technology from the University of Cape Coast (UCC) and works as a Quality Assurance Executive in Ghana's pharmaceutical industry. His professional career is built on research, accuracy, compliance, and evidence-based decision-making. These same principles guide his approach to personal finance and investing.

Like many Ghanaians, Robert once believed that investing was only for people with large amounts of money. As he began researching Ghana's financial markets and regulated investment opportunities, he discovered that ordinary people could start building wealth with surprisingly small amounts through products such as Treasury Bills, money market funds, digital savings platforms, and the Ghana Stock Exchange.

At the same time, he observed a growing number of people losing their hard-earned money to fraudulent investment schemes simply because they lacked access to reliable financial education. That realization inspired him to establish Robayer WealthLab: a platform dedicated to simplifying finance, promoting financial literacy, and helping people make confident, informed financial decisions.

Rather than promoting shortcuts or unrealistic promises, Robert advocates a simple philosophy: lasting wealth is built through knowledge, consistency, discipline, and time. His goal is to help readers understand how money works, avoid costly financial mistakes, and use legitimate investment opportunities to create a more secure financial future.

Small Cedis, Big Wealth is the first publication from Robayer WealthLab and reflects Robert's vision of making practical financial education accessible to everyone, whether they are starting with GH¢1 or GH¢100,000.

He hopes this book will not only change how readers think about money but also inspire them to take the first step toward building wealth with confidence.

"I believe wealth is not reserved for people who earn the most. It belongs to those who continuously learn, make wise financial decisions, and remain disciplined enough to stay the course. My mission is to help you build that journey, one smart decision at a time."

Robert Loh Kobla

Founder, Robayer WealthLab

Why I Wrote This Book

For a long time, I believed investing was something reserved for people with money.

I thought Treasury Bills were meant for politicians, large companies, and wealthy individuals. I assumed the Ghana Stock Exchange was a place where only millionaires invested, and I believed that building wealth required earning a very high income before you could even think about investing.

Like many people, I focused almost entirely on earning money and saving what I could, without truly understanding how money grows. The more I looked around, the more I realized that many hardworking Ghanaians shared the same beliefs. We were taught how to work for money, but very few of us were taught how to make money work for us.

As I began researching Ghana's financial system, I discovered something that completely changed my perspective. I learned that many legitimate investment opportunities are available to ordinary people with surprisingly small amounts of money. Treasury Bills, money market funds, regulated digital investment platforms, and even shares listed on the Ghana Stock Exchange are far more accessible than most people realize.

At the same time, I discovered something equally concerning. While genuine investment opportunities remain largely unknown, fraudulent investment schemes continue to attract thousands of unsuspecting people with promises of unrealistic returns. Too many hardworking individuals lose their savings because they lack access to reliable financial education.

That realization inspired me to create Robayer WealthLab.

My goal is simple: to help people separate facts from hype, understand how legitimate investments work, and make informed financial decisions with confidence. I believe financial education should be practical, easy to understand, and based on evidence, not on fear, speculation, or unrealistic promises.

This book is the first step in that mission.

Everything in the chapters ahead has been written in plain language, using real Ghanaian examples, realistic figures, and regulated investment options. I want you to understand not only where to invest, but also why an investment works, what risks it carries, and how to recognize opportunities that should be avoided.

If this book helps you avoid one scam, make one wise financial decision, or begin investing with confidence, even if it's with just GH¢1, then it has achieved exactly what I hoped it would.

Welcome to Robayer WealthLab.

Let's begin building your financial future, one smart decision at a time.

Table of Contents

FRONT MATTER

Copyright & Disclaimer	2
About Robayer WealthLab	3
About the Author	4
Why I Wrote This Book	5

INTRODUCTION

Introduction: Why Small Money Can Build Big Wealth in Ghana	8
---	---

CHAPTERS

1 Mobile Money Susu & Digital Savings Wallets	9
2 Treasury Bills, Ghana's Safest Real Investment	12
3 Money Market Funds & Mutual Funds	14
4 IC Wealth and Other Licensed Wealth Platforms	16
5 The Ghana Stock Exchange	18
6 Traditional Bank Savings & Fixed Deposits	20
7 Petty Trading & Skills	22
8 How to Spot and Avoid Investment Scams in Ghana	24
9 Your 6-Month Action Plan	25

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

Frequently Asked Questions	26
Bonus Chapter: 10 Biggest Money Mistakes Ghanaians Make	27
Bonus: The 30-Day Wealth Challenge	28
Bonus: Investment Due-Diligence Checklist	30
Bonus: Financial Goal Worksheet	31
Bonus: Official Resource Links	32

BACK MATTER

Glossary	33
Appendix: Side-by-Side Comparison	35
Continue Your Wealth Journey	36
Other Books by Robayer WealthLab	37

Introduction: Why Small Money Can Build Big Wealth in Ghana

If you've ever felt like GH¢1 or GH¢50 is too small to matter, this book was written to change your mind, with facts, not hype. Inflation quietly shrinks cash sitting idle. A salary that arrives and disappears before month-end never gets the chance to grow. And every day, adverts promise Ghanaians impossible returns, while the real, regulated tools that actually work sit largely unknown or ignored.

This book closes that gap. Each chapter that follows covers one real way to put GH¢1–500 to work in Ghana today: what it is, exactly how it earns you money, how to start it this week, the true minimum amount required, and a realistic, not exaggerated, picture of what it could grow into over time.

You will also meet the one chapter every other guide leaves out: how to spot the platforms designed to take your money, not grow it. In a market full of noise, that knowledge alone can be worth more than any return.

Look out for three recurring features as you read: a WealthLab Tip in every chapter (a practical habit that improves your outcome), a WealthLab Warning (a specific risk to guard against), and a real-life example showing what consistent, disciplined use of that chapter's strategy could realistically build over time.

CHAPTER 1 OF 9

1 Mobile Money Susu & Digital Savings Wallets

"I don't even feel it leaving my wallet, and yet by December, I have real money saved."

This is the entry point almost every Ghanaian can start today, with the phone already in your pocket.

WHAT IT IS

Susu is Ghana's traditional daily/weekly savings system, now rebuilt inside mobile money. MTN Mobile Money alone offers three savings products through its MoMo menu: Pesewa Susu (with Republic Bank), Yello Save (with Fidelity Bank), and Sika Save, a two-in-one savings-and-investment product. A newer generation of fintech savings wallets, such as EasySave inside the Fido app and held with Access Bank, pay meaningfully higher interest than a basic susu account and round out the options.

This is not an "investment" in the sense of chasing high returns. It is the foundation everything else in this book is built on: a safe place to build the habit and the capital before you move into higher-return products.

HOW IT ACTUALLY GENERATES YOUR RETURN

With Pesewa Susu, spare pesewas left in your MoMo wallet at the end of each day are automatically swept into a savings account, and you can also set a fixed daily, weekly, or monthly susu amount to be moved automatically. Republic Bank holds the money and currently pays around 6% per year (variable), credited quarterly.

Yello Save, run in partnership with Fidelity Bank, works as a straightforward digital savings account linked to your MoMo wallet: you deposit, watch it earn interest, up to roughly 8% per year depending on your balance tier, and withdraw anytime, with interest paid out monthly.

Sika Save splits whatever you set aside into two parts: a Savings Account and an Investment Account, using a ratio you choose (a 50/50 split by default, adjustable). The savings portion behaves like Yello Save; the investment portion is placed to target a higher return, with combined yields reported in the roughly 8–10% per year range. Because MTN has toggled Sika Save and Pesewa Susu on and off at different times, always confirm current availability in your MoMo menu before relying on a specific product.

With EasySave (Fido), your money is held at Access Bank, a Bank of Ghana-licensed institution, and currently earns up to 10% per year, calculated daily on your balance from the very first cedi, with no lock-in and free withdrawals to your MoMo wallet.

Across all four, the return comes from the same place a normal bank savings account's return comes from: a partner bank lends out or invests pooled deposits and pays you a share as interest. The digital wrapper just removes the queues and paperwork.

HOW TO START

1. For Pesewa Susu, Yello Save, or Sika Save: dial *170#, select "Financial Services", then "Savings", and choose the product you want to register for, each will prompt you to set a deposit amount and frequency (daily, weekly, or monthly).

2. For EasySave: download the Fido app, register with your Ghana Card, open EasySave from the home screen, and make your first deposit from your linked MoMo wallet, deposits as small as GH¢20 are accepted.
3. Automate it. Set your deduction for the day your money enters your wallet (salary day, market day), so saving happens before you have a chance to spend it.
4. Once your balance crosses roughly GH¢100–500, consider moving a portion into a Treasury Bill or money market fund for a higher return, keeping the mobile savings wallet as your emergency buffer.

MOBILE SAVINGS OPTIONS AT A GLANCE

PRODUCT	BANK PARTNER	EST. INTEREST	HOW TO ACCESS
Pesewa Susu	Republic Bank	6% p.a. (variable), paid quarterly	*170# > Financial Services > Savings > Pesewa Susu
Yello Save	Fidelity Bank	Up to 8% p.a., paid monthly	*170# > Financial Services > Savings > Yello Save
Sika Save	MTN savings + investment split	Roughly 8–10% p.a. (varies by split)	*170# > Financial Services > Savings > Sika Save
EasySave (Fido app)	Access Bank	Up to 10% p.a., grows daily	Fido app > EasySave > Make first deposit

Quick Facts

Minimum to start: As low as GH¢1–20 depending on the platform

Best for: Absolute beginners, building the savings habit, emergency funds

Risk level: Very Low

WEALTHLAB TIP

Automate your deduction for the exact day money enters your wallet, before you have a chance to spend it. Willpower is unreliable; automation is not.

WEALTHLAB WARNING

Traditional in-person susu collectors are not regulated and earn zero interest, your money is only as safe as that individual's honesty. Prefer a bank- or Bank of Ghana-licensed digital option instead, and always check that a specific MTN product (Pesewa Susu and Sika Save especially) is currently active before depositing.

Real-Life Example: Efua, a market trader

Efua saves GH¢50 every month through EasySave at roughly 10% annual interest.

After 3 years, her account holds approximately GH¢2,075 (from GH¢1,800 contributed).

After 5 years, that grows to approximately GH¢3,828 (from GH¢3,000 contributed).

The lesson isn't the size of the number. It's that showing up every month, automatically, is what made it happen.

Illustrative growth at 10% per year (the upper end of this category, EasySave and Sika Save's investment split; Pesewa Susu and Yello Save typically run lower, in the 6–8% range)

STARTING AMOUNT	AFTER 1 YEAR	AFTER 2 YEARS	AFTER 3 YEARS
-----------------	--------------	---------------	---------------

GH¢100	GH¢110	GH¢121	GH¢133
GH¢500	GH¢550	GH¢605	GH¢666
GH¢1,000	GH¢1,100	GH¢1,210	GH¢1,331

WHAT TO WATCH OUT FOR

- "Sweeping" small pesewas won't build serious wealth on its own, treat it as your habit-building layer, not your main strategy.
- MTN's own savings products (Pesewa Susu, Sika Save) have periods of being unavailable. If the menu option is missing, it doesn't mean your money is at risk; it likely means the product is temporarily inactive.

Sources: Republic Bank (Ghana) Pesewa Susu product terms; MTN Ghana Help Centre (Sika Save); Fidelity Bank Yello Save terms and conditions; Fido Ghana EasySave FAQ and product pages.

2 Treasury Bills, Ghana's Safest Real Investment

This is the single most important chapter in this book. If you only ever do one thing after reading this, do this.

WHAT IT IS

A Treasury Bill (T-Bill) is a short-term loan you make to the Government of Ghana. In exchange, the government promises to pay you back more than you lent, after a fixed period: 91, 182, or 364 days. It is issued and backed by the Bank of Ghana, making it one of the lowest-risk investments available in the country.

HOW IT ACTUALLY GENERATES YOUR RETURN

You buy the bill at a discount to its face value. For example, you might pay GH¢44,665 today for a bill that pays out GH¢50,000 in 182 days. The GH¢5,335 difference is your return, built into the price rather than paid as separate "interest."

Rates are set weekly through Bank of Ghana auctions and move with the broader economy. As of mid-2026, published rates across the three tenors have generally ranged in the mid-20s percent per year, though this shifts over time, always check the current rate before you commit.

As of mid-2026, T-Bill interest is not subject to withholding tax in Ghana, unlike fixed deposits (which attract an 8% withholding tax), meaning the return you see quoted is close to what actually lands in your pocket. Always confirm current tax treatment, as rules can change.

HOW TO START

1. Decide your platform. Commercial banks (GCB, Ecobank, Fidelity, Stanbic, CalBank) and licensed investment houses (Databank, IC Group, and others) all sell T-Bills. Mobile-money-based options such as Ecobank's TBILL4ALL let you invest with an MTN MoMo balance from as little as a few cedis, though GH¢100+ is more practical.
2. Open an investment account with your chosen provider. This usually needs a Ghana Card, a passport photo, and either an existing bank/MoMo account or a same-day account opening.
3. Choose your tenor: 91 days if you may need the cash soon, 364 days if you can lock it away for the highest yield.
4. Submit a "non-competitive" bid if you are a first-time small investor. This simply means you accept whatever the auction-clearing rate turns out to be, which is the simplest route for beginners.
5. At maturity, choose to withdraw your money plus return, or roll it straight into a new bill to keep compounding.

Quick Facts

Minimum to start: Officially GH¢100 at Bank of Ghana auctions; GH¢500 is the practical minimum at most banks and investment houses

Best for: Anyone who wants a safe, government-backed way to beat inflation and bank savings rates

Risk level: Very Low

WEALTHLAB TIP

Set a calendar reminder for your T-Bill's maturity date so you actively decide to roll over or withdraw, rather than leaving it to chance.

WEALTHLAB WARNING

Your money is effectively locked for the chosen tenor. Never invest T-Bill money that you might need before it matures.

Real-Life Example: Kwame, a civil servant

Kwame commits to investing GH¢200 every month into rolling 91-day T-Bills at an average rate of roughly 25% per year.

After 5 years, his investment is worth approximately GH¢21,863 (from GH¢12,000 contributed).

After 10 years, it grows to approximately GH¢88,583 (from GH¢24,000 contributed).

The rate isn't guaranteed to stay at 25% for a decade, but the discipline of monthly reinvestment is what does the heavy lifting here, not luck.

Illustrative growth at 25% per year (mid-2026 approximate T-Bill range; reinvested at maturity; actual rates move weekly and are not guaranteed)

STARTING AMOUNT	AFTER 1 YEAR	AFTER 2 YEARS	AFTER 3 YEARS
GH¢100	GH¢125	GH¢156	GH¢195
GH¢500	GH¢625	GH¢781	GH¢977
GH¢1,000	GH¢1,250	GH¢1,563	GH¢1,953

WHAT TO WATCH OUT FOR

- "Safe" does not mean "unlimited upside." T-Bills protect capital and beat savings accounts; they are not a route to fast riches.
- Rates change weekly, always check the current published rate before committing.

Sources: Bank of Ghana Treasury Bill Rates page; treasurybillrateghana.com; Ecobank Ghana TBILL4ALL product information.

CHAPTER 3 OF 9

3 Money Market Funds & Mutual Funds

Want a professional fund manager working your small money alongside thousands of other Ghanaians' money, without needing GH¢50,000 to get their attention? This is how.

WHAT IT IS

A mutual fund (or unit trust) pools money from many investors and is managed by a licensed fund manager who invests it in a mix of assets (T-Bills, bonds, and sometimes stocks) on everyone's behalf. You buy "units" of the fund; as the underlying investments grow, the value of your units grows too.

Ghana's best-known examples include Databank's MFUND (the country's first money market fund, launched in 2004) and its sister funds BFUND, EPACK and ARKFUND, and the IC Liquidity Fund managed by IC Asset Managers (Ghana) Ltd, part of the IC Group.

HOW IT ACTUALLY GENERATES YOUR RETURN

The fund manager invests the pooled money in interest-generating instruments: largely government securities and bank placements for money market funds, or a mix including equities for growth-focused funds. The fund's daily price reflects the current market value of everything it holds.

Your return comes from a combination of interest income and, for equity-inclusive funds, capital appreciation, minus the fund's management fee, which is disclosed in its prospectus.

Because a professional manager makes the day-to-day decisions, this suits people who want their money invested but don't want to personally track weekly T-Bill auctions or stock prices.

HOW TO START

1. Choose a licensed manager. Databank Financial Services or IC Asset Managers (Ghana) Ltd are two of the largest and most established.
2. Open an account online (e.g. via wealth.ic.africa, using onboarding.ic.africa) or at a branch, with a Ghana Card and a passport photo.
3. Fund your account by mobile money, bank transfer, debit/credit card, or expressPay.
4. Start small and top up regularly. Many funds let you add money whenever you have it, which suits irregular incomes such as trading or freelance work.
5. Track performance through the provider's app or portal, and request withdrawals when needed; most money market funds pay out within one business day.

Quick Facts

Minimum to start: As low as GH¢1 to open the IC Liquidity Fund; Databank funds are accessible from small regular contributions

Best for: People who want professional management without actively managing individual T-Bills or stocks

Risk level: Low

Ask for the fund's fact sheet and fee schedule before investing, a 2% annual fee sounds small but compounds against you meaningfully over a decade.

WEALTHLAB WARNING

A money market fund should be conservative. If a fund promises equity-like returns with money-market-like safety, ask hard questions before investing.

Real-Life Example: Ama, a young professional

Ama invests GH¢100 every month into a money market fund averaging roughly 20% per year.

After 5 years, her fund units are worth approximately GH¢9,722 (from GH¢6,000 contributed).

After 10 years, that grows to approximately GH¢33,912 (from GH¢12,000 contributed).

She never had to time a single T-Bill auction. The fund manager did that work for her.

Illustrative growth at 20% per year (representative conservative money-market-fund range; actual fund performance varies by manager and market conditions and is never guaranteed)

STARTING AMOUNT	AFTER 1 YEAR	AFTER 2 YEARS	AFTER 3 YEARS
GH¢100	GH¢120	GH¢144	GH¢173
GH¢500	GH¢600	GH¢720	GH¢864
GH¢1,000	GH¢1,200	GH¢1,440	GH¢1,728

WHAT TO WATCH OUT FOR

- Funds charge management fees, always ask for the fee schedule and factor it into your expected return.
- Only invest through SEC-licensed fund managers, check a firm's license status if you're unsure.

Sources: IC Liquidity Fund product page and FAQs (ic.africa); Databank Group product pages.

CHAPTER 4 OF 9

4 IC Wealth and Other Licensed Wealth Platforms, and a Warning You Need to Read

This chapter could save you your entire capital. Read it slowly.

THE REAL IC WEALTH

IC Wealth (wealth.ic.africa) is the digital investment platform of IC Group, run through its licensed subsidiary IC Asset Managers (Ghana) Ltd, which is regulated by Ghana's Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) and the National Pensions Regulatory Authority (NPRA). Through the platform you can access the IC Liquidity Fund (from GH¢1), Government of Ghana Treasury Bills via its Tradelive service, and direct stock trading on the Ghana Stock Exchange, all from one account, with a financial advisor available for guidance.

This is a legitimate, professionally managed platform suitable for a first-time investor building a diversified small portfolio.

THE WARNING: A DIFFERENT "IC WEALTH" IS A SCAM

During research for this book, a second, unrelated website was found using a very similar name and advertising "30% weekly returns," guaranteed payouts "every Tuesday," and claims of "15,000+ satisfied investors," with a \$1,000 minimum. This is not a typo. It genuinely claims 30% per week.

Do the maths: no legitimate business on earth, whether bank, fund, or stock market, sustainably pays 30% a week. At that rate, GH¢1,000 would become over GH¢1.3 million within a single year if compounded weekly. If that sounds impossible, that's because it is. This is the classic structure of a Ponzi scheme: early "investors" are paid from the deposits of new investors, not from any real underlying investment, until the scheme collapses and the last people in lose everything.

WEALTHLAB TIP

Bookmark the official web address directly rather than relying on a search result or a link from an advert. Scam sites often buy ads targeting the exact same keywords as the real institution.

WEALTHLAB WARNING

If a platform's name looks familiar but the promised return sounds unbelievable, assume it's a copy, not the original, verify directly with the real institution before sending any money.

HOW TO TELL A REAL INVESTMENT PLATFORM FROM A FAKE ONE

- A real return is never guaranteed and is never dramatically higher than the Treasury Bill rate for a similar time period.
- Check the SEC Ghana and Bank of Ghana websites for a list of licensed fund managers, banks, and dealers, and confirm the exact company name and registration number.
- Legitimate platforms explain, in plain terms, what they actually invest your money in. If a platform can't explain where the return comes from, don't invest.
- Be suspicious of pressure to recruit others to increase your payout. This is a hallmark of pyramid and Ponzi structures, not investing.

- Confirm you are on the correct, official web address before entering any personal or financial details.

Quick Facts, IC Wealth (legitimate platform)

Minimum to start: from GH¢1 (IC Liquidity Fund)

Best for: A single account to access funds, T-Bills, and stocks together

Risk level: Low to Medium, depending on the product chosen within the platform

Sources: IC Group / IC Wealth official product pages (wealth.ic.africa, ic.africa); comparison against a separately identified website advertising unrealistic guaranteed weekly returns, evaluated against standard Ponzi-scheme warning signs.

CHAPTER 5 OF 9

5 The Ghana Stock Exchange, Owning a Piece of Real Companies

Every time you buy airtime, groceries, or fuel, some of that money flows to a company. Owning shares means some of that flow can start coming back to you.

WHAT IT IS

A share (or stock) is a small unit of ownership in a real company. When you buy shares of a company listed on the Ghana Stock Exchange (GSE), such as banks, breweries, or telecom firms, you become a part-owner, entitled to a proportional share of its profits and its growth in value over time.

HOW IT ACTUALLY GENERATES YOUR RETURN

You can earn from shares in two ways: the share price rising over time (capital appreciation) as the company grows, and dividends: a portion of company profit paid directly to shareholders, usually once or twice a year.

Some GSE-listed shares trade for well under GH¢1 per share, meaning GH¢500 can realistically buy a meaningful number of shares across a couple of companies through a licensed stockbroker.

Unlike T-Bills, there is no fixed, promised return, share prices can rise or fall with company performance and the broader market, which is why stocks are held for the long term rather than treated as a place to "park" money you need soon.

HOW TO START

1. Open a trading account with a licensed stockbroker or dealing member of the GSE. Options include IC Securities, Databank, EDC Investments, and others.
2. Complete KYC with your Ghana Card and a passport photo; most brokers now offer this online.
3. Fund your account by mobile money or bank transfer.
4. Start with shares of companies whose businesses you understand and can follow, and consider spreading GH¢500 across two or three companies rather than putting it all in one.
5. Plan to hold for years, not weeks. Short-term stock trading is high-risk and not what this chapter is describing.

Quick Facts

Minimum to start: From around GH¢50–100 depending on share price and broker minimums

Best for: Investors with a multi-year horizon who can tolerate ups and downs for potentially higher long-term growth

Risk level: Higher (short-term); moderate over the long term with diversification

WEALTHLAB TIP

Reinvest your dividends instead of spending them. This is one of the most powerful, and most ignored, wealth-building habits on the GSE.

WEALTHLAB WARNING

Never invest money in stocks that you might need within the next 1–2 years, short-term price swings can work against you.

Real-Life Example: Kojo, a small business owner

Kojo invests GH¢150 every month into a spread of GSE-listed shares averaging roughly 15% per year over the long run.

After 10 years, his portfolio is worth approximately GH¢38,996 (from GH¢18,000 contributed).

After 15 years, that grows to approximately GH¢91,384 (from GH¢27,000 contributed).

Along the way, some years were down years. The growth came from staying invested through them, not from timing the market perfectly.

Illustrative growth at 15% per year (a representative long-run average; annual results are volatile and can be negative; this is not a promised return)

STARTING AMOUNT	AFTER 1 YEAR	AFTER 2 YEARS	AFTER 3 YEARS
GH¢100	GH¢115	GH¢132	GH¢152
GH¢500	GH¢575	GH¢661	GH¢760
GH¢1,000	GH¢1,150	GH¢1,323	GH¢1,521

WHAT TO WATCH OUT FOR

- Diversify. Putting all your capital into one company's shares concentrates your risk unnecessarily.
- Only trade through a licensed dealing member of the Ghana Stock Exchange.

Sources: Ghana Stock Exchange listed company data; IC Wealth stock trading product page.

CHAPTER 6 OF 9

6 Traditional Bank Savings & Fixed Deposits

The oldest tool in the book, still useful if you know exactly where it fits.

WHAT IT IS

A savings account is a standard interest-bearing bank account you can deposit into and withdraw from at any time. A fixed deposit is different: you lock a sum away with the bank for an agreed period in exchange for a higher, fixed interest rate than an ordinary savings account.

HOW IT ACTUALLY GENERATES YOUR RETURN

The bank pays you interest for the use of your money while it lends it out or invests it elsewhere. Ghanaian banks typically pay 5–12% per year on ordinary savings accounts, credited monthly or quarterly.

Fixed deposits generally pay more but currently attract an 8% withholding tax on the interest earned in Ghana, reducing your effective return compared with tax-free products like T-Bills.

Deposits at Bank of Ghana-licensed banks are protected up to GH¢6,250 per depositor by the Ghana Deposit Protection Corporation.

HOW TO START

1. Visit any licensed commercial bank branch, or complete account opening through their app, with a Ghana Card and a passport photo.
2. For a fixed deposit, specify the amount and tenor you want to lock in and compare the quoted rate against current T-Bill rates before committing.
3. Set up mobile money linkage so you can fund and monitor the account without visiting a branch.

Quick Facts

Minimum to start: Ordinary savings from as little as GH¢1–50 depending on the bank; fixed deposits typically require GH¢500–1,000+

Best for: People who want the reassurance of a full-service bank relationship and deposit protection

Risk level: Very Low

WEALTHLAB TIP

Compare the fixed deposit rate against the current T-Bill rate before locking your money away. T-Bills are often more competitive and untaxed.

WEALTHLAB WARNING

Breaking a fixed deposit early typically forfeits some or all of the interest you've earned.

Real-Life Example: Abena, a first-time saver

Abena locks GH¢500 into a 182-day fixed deposit at roughly 8% net of tax.

At maturity, she receives approximately GH¢520, modest, but predictable and fully protected.

She uses the payout as the seed capital for her first Treasury Bill investment in Chapter 2.

Illustrative growth at 8% per year after tax (mid-range fixed deposit; ordinary savings accounts typically earn less)

STARTING AMOUNT	AFTER 1 YEAR	AFTER 2 YEARS	AFTER 3 YEARS
GH¢100	GH¢108	GH¢117	GH¢126
GH¢500	GH¢540	GH¢583	GH¢630
GH¢1,000	GH¢1,080	GH¢1,166	GH¢1,260

WHAT TO WATCH OUT FOR

- Ordinary savings rates often sit below inflation, meaning your money's buying power can shrink even while the balance grows.

Sources: General Ghanaian commercial bank savings/fixed deposit disclosures; Ghana Deposit Protection Corporation coverage limit.

CHAPTER 7 OF 9

7 Petty Trading & Skills, Your Highest-Return Asset Is You

Every chapter so far has covered financial products where someone else grows your money. This chapter is different: at GH¢1–500, one of the most realistic ways to see fast, significant returns is by investing in small trade stock or a skill that increases your own earning power.

WHAT IT IS

Buying a small amount of stock (phone accessories, provisions, secondhand (obroni wawu) clothing, cosmetics, farm produce) to resell at a markup; or spending part of your GH¢500 on a short, practical course or certification (tailoring, hairdressing, digital skills, driving) that increases what you can earn.

HOW IT GENERATES A RETURN

Trading margins in small retail commonly range from 15% to 50% per cycle, depending on the goods and how quickly you turn over stock. Unlike the financial products in this book, though, this return depends entirely on your own effort, time, and market knowledge, and carries real business risk (unsold stock, price competition, spoilage for perishables).

A skill or certification doesn't pay a "rate." It raises your income ceiling directly. GH¢200–500 spent on a recognised short course can be the difference between casual, unpredictable income and a stable trade that supports consistent saving and investing through the rest of this book.

HOW TO START

1. Pick one product category you already understand as a buyer. You'll spot good deals and price expectations faster.
2. Start with the smallest viable batch, sell it fully, and only then reinvest profit into a larger batch.
3. Track every cedi in and out from day one, even informally in a notebook or phone notes app.
4. Once trading profit or new-skill income is flowing, route a fixed portion, even 10%, into the susu, T-Bill, or fund options from earlier chapters.

Quick Facts

Minimum to start: GH¢50–500 depending on goods or course chosen

Best for: Anyone willing to put in active time and effort, not just capital

Risk level: Variable, depends heavily on your own execution and the market

WEALTHLAB TIP

Reinvest a fixed percentage of every trading profit cycle, even 10%, into one of the financial products earlier in this book, so your active income starts generating passive income too.

WEALTHLAB WARNING

Don't ignore your own labour costs. If you're not pricing your time into your margin, you may be working for less than you think.

Real-Life Example: Yaa, a hairdressing apprentice

Yaa spends GH¢300 on a short professional certification course.

Within 6 months, her ability to take on higher-paying clients raises her average monthly income from roughly GH¢400 to GH¢900.

Results like this depend heavily on effort, local demand, and the specific skill chosen. This is an illustrative example, not a guaranteed outcome.

This is the one chapter in this book where the return is not something a table can honestly project. It depends on you. Treat every figure elsewhere in this book as a benchmark for what your trading profit should eventually be reinvested into.

CHAPTER 8 OF 9

8 How to Spot and Avoid Investment Scams in Ghana

Ghana's growing appetite for investing has, unfortunately, attracted people who exploit it. This short chapter could be worth more to you than every other chapter combined, because avoiding a single scam preserves everything you build with the rest of this book.

THE WARNING SIGNS

- Guaranteed high, fixed returns, especially anything promising weekly or daily payouts.
- Returns dramatically above the prevailing Treasury Bill rate, with no clear explanation of what the money is actually invested in.
- Pressure to recruit others, with your own payout tied to how many people you bring in.
- Urgency and scarcity tactics ("offer closes tonight," "only 10 slots left") designed to stop you from doing due diligence.
- Payment requested only through personal mobile money numbers rather than a registered corporate or escrow account.
- A company name that closely mimics a real, licensed institution.

A REAL, CURRENT EXAMPLE, NOT A HYPOTHETICAL ONE

This chapter isn't describing a theoretical risk. Ghana's Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) has publicly warned against 23 unlicensed investment entities operating in the country, and published the full list for anyone to check: SEC warns against 23 unlicensed investment entities in Ghana; full list (bit.ly/4bD2PSe).

Before you invest in anything unfamiliar, check the SEC's current public warnings alongside its list of licensed operators. A platform that isn't on the licensed list, or that is named in a warning like this one, is not a grey area: it's a company you should not send money to.

DUE DILIGENCE CHECKLIST BEFORE YOU INVEST ANYWHERE

1. Search the SEC Ghana list of licensed operators, and its published list of unlicensed or flagged entities, and confirm the exact registered name.
2. Ask directly: "What does my money get invested in, specifically?"
3. Search the company name plus the word "scam" or "review" before committing any money.
4. Start with the smallest possible amount first, and only increase your investment after you've successfully withdrawn a payout.
5. If in doubt, default to the fully regulated, well-established options in Chapters 2, 3, and 4.

REMEMBER

If a return sounds too good to be true compared to everything else in this book, it is.

No legitimate investment in Ghana currently pays anywhere near a guaranteed 30% per week.

9 Your 6-Month Action Plan

Reading is the easy part. Here is a simple sequence to actually put GH¢1–500 to work, in order.

MONTH 1: FOUNDATION

- Open a digital savings wallet (Chapter 1) and automate a small daily or weekly susu amount, even GH¢5.
- Research and shortlist one licensed platform each for T-Bills and a money market fund (Chapters 2–3).

MONTH 2: FIRST REAL INVESTMENT

- Once your savings wallet reaches GH¢100–500, move it into your first Treasury Bill or money market fund investment.
- Set a calendar reminder for your maturity/rollover date.

MONTHS 3–4: DIVERSIFY

- Start a second stream, either GSE shares (Chapter 5) with a small allocation, or trade stock/skills investment (Chapter 7).
- Continue your automated susu contribution without interruption.

MONTHS 5–6: REINFORCE AND REVIEW

- Reinvest T-Bill or fund maturity proceeds rather than spending them, to start compounding.
- Review what's working, cut what isn't, and re-run Chapter 8's checklist on anything new you're tempted to try.

WEALTHLAB TIP

Print or screenshot the 30-Day Wealth Challenge later in this book and pin it somewhere you'll see it daily. Month 1 gets dramatically easier with a visible checklist.

There is no version of this plan that turns GH¢500 into life-changing wealth in six months, and any book that tells you otherwise is asking you to believe something the maths in Chapter 2 already disproves. What this plan does do is put you months ahead of where you are today, with real capital working in real, regulated instruments, and the habits and knowledge to keep growing it for years.

Frequently Asked Questions

Can students invest with these small amounts?

Yes. Every option in this book, from digital savings wallets to T-Bills, accepts amounts well within a student budget. Start with Chapter 1 and build up from there.

Can I invest using only MoMo, without a bank account?

For many products, yes: Pesewa Susu, EasySave, and mobile-money-based T-Bill routes like TBILL4ALL all work directly from a MoMo wallet. Some mutual funds and stockbroking accounts may still require linking a bank account eventually.

Can foreigners or non-residents invest in Ghanaian T-Bills, funds, or stocks?

Generally yes, though requirements (documentation, tax treatment) differ from those for Ghanaian citizens. Confirm directly with your chosen bank or investment house.

Do I pay tax on these investments?

As of mid-2026, T-Bill interest is not subject to withholding tax, while bank fixed deposits attract an 8% withholding tax. Fund and stock taxation depends on the product, always confirm current rules with your provider, as tax treatment can change.

Can I withdraw my money anytime?

It depends on the product. Digital savings wallets and money market funds are generally flexible (often within one business day). T-Bills and fixed deposits are locked until maturity. Stocks can typically be sold within a few business days, but their value may be up or down when you do.

How much should I start with?

Start with whatever you can comfortably save without affecting your essential expenses. Even GH¢1–20 in a digital savings wallet is a valid starting point. Consistency matters more than the size of your first deposit.

What if I lose my job or income drops?

Prioritise your emergency fund (Chapter 1) above all else. Pause new contributions to T-Bills, funds, or stocks if needed. Most of these products don't penalise you for simply not adding more, only for withdrawing locked funds early.

Is any of this guaranteed to make me rich?

No, and be wary of anyone who tells you otherwise. This book is about steady, realistic, compounding growth using regulated products, not guaranteed riches.

Bonus Chapter: 10 Biggest Money Mistakes Ghanaians Make

Avoiding these ten habits will likely do more for your long-term wealth than any single investment product in this book.

1. Keeping all your money in MoMo

A wallet is for spending and short-term liquidity, not for growing wealth. Money sitting in MoMo alone earns little to nothing while inflation quietly erodes its value.

2. Buying liabilities before assets

Spending on things that cost you money every month (the latest phone on credit, for example) before you've built any income-generating assets keeps you financially fragile.

3. Following WhatsApp and Telegram investment groups blindly

Many of these groups exist purely to funnel members into Ponzi schemes. Verify everything independently using Chapter 8's checklist.

4. Ignoring inflation

Cash sitting idle loses purchasing power every year, even if the balance never changes. "Safe" in your pocket is not the same as "safe" in value.

5. Not budgeting at all

Without knowing where your money goes, you can't know how much is realistically available to save or invest each month.

6. Chasing the highest advertised return instead of the safest realistic one

The instinct to chase the biggest number is exactly what scam platforms exploit. Compare any offer against the honest benchmarks in this book first.

7. Withdrawing investments the moment they dip

Especially with stocks and equity funds, reacting to short-term drops locks in losses that would likely have recovered if you'd stayed invested.

8. Mixing emergency funds with long-term investments

Locking your entire safety net into a 364-day T-Bill means an emergency forces you to break it early, often at a cost.

9. Not diversifying at all

Putting 100% of your capital into one platform, one stock, or one trader concentrates risk that a small amount of spreading out would have reduced.

10. Never revisiting your plan

Rates change, life circumstances change, and platforms change. A plan set once and never reviewed slowly drifts out of date.

Bonus: The 30-Day Wealth Challenge

A simple, one-task-a-day plan to move from reading this book to actually acting on it.

DAY	TASK
1	Track every cedi you spend today, no changes yet, just awareness.
2	Open a digital savings wallet (Chapter 1) if you don't already have one.
3	Read Chapter 2 (Treasury Bills) in full.
4	List your monthly income and fixed expenses on paper or in your phone.
5	Calculate what you could realistically save each month.
6	Set your first automated susu deduction, even if it's GH¢5.
7	Review Week 1, what surprised you about your spending?
8	Read Chapter 3 (Money Market & Mutual Funds).
9	Shortlist one licensed T-Bill provider and one fund manager.
10	Gather your Ghana Card and a passport photo for account opening.
11	Start (or continue researching) opening an investment account.
12	Read Chapter 4 and bookmark the official IC Wealth web address.
13	Read Chapter 8 (Scam Warning Signs), twice.
14	Review Week 2, are you any closer to your first real investment?
15	Read Chapter 5 (GSE Stocks).
16	Research two or three GSE-listed companies whose products you use.
17	Read Chapter 6 (Bank Savings & Fixed Deposits).
18	Compare your bank's savings rate against the current T-Bill rate.
19	Read Chapter 7 (Petty Trading & Skills).
20	Identify one skill or trade idea that fits your interests and budget.
21	Review Week 3, pick your first product to actually invest in.
22	Complete account opening with your chosen T-Bill or fund provider.
23	Make your first real investment, even if it's just GH¢100.
24	Set a calendar reminder for your maturity or rollover date.
25	Fill in the Financial Goal Worksheet later in this book.
26	Complete the Investment Checklist for anything new you're considering.
27	Share one thing you've learned this month with a friend or family member.
28	Review your full month of spending against Day 1's baseline.
29	Decide your Month 2 target: how much will you invest next?

30	Celebrate. You've gone from reading about investing to actually doing it.
----	---

Bonus: Investment Due-Diligence Checklist

Copy or print this page. Run through it before you invest in anything new, no exceptions, regardless of who recommended it.

- ☐ Is the company or platform licensed by the Bank of Ghana, SEC Ghana, or NPRA (as applicable)?
- ☐ Have I confirmed the exact registered company name, not just a similar-sounding one?
- ☐ Does it promise a fixed, guaranteed return that sounds higher than the current T-Bill rate?
- ☐ Have I verified I'm on the official website, typed directly rather than clicked from an ad?
- ☐ Can I clearly explain, in one sentence, what my money will actually be invested in?
- ☐ Am I being pressured to recruit others or act before a deadline?
- ☐ Have I searched the company name alongside the word "scam" or "review"?
- ☐ Am I investing only money I can afford to have locked away or, in the worst case, lose?
- ☐ Have I started with a small test amount rather than my full available capital?

WEALTHLAB WARNING

If you answered "no" or "not sure" to any of the licensing or transparency questions above, do not invest until you can answer "yes."

Bonus: Financial Goal Worksheet

Fill this in by hand, or copy it into a notes app. Revisit it every 3 months.

YOUR CURRENT NUMBERS

Monthly income	
Monthly essential expenses	
Monthly amount available to save/invest	
Current emergency fund balance	
Emergency fund target (3–6 months expenses)	

YOUR INVESTMENT PLAN

Monthly susu / digital savings amount	
Monthly Treasury Bill / fund contribution	
Other investment (stocks, trading, skills)	
1-year goal	
5-year goal	

NET WORTH TRACKER

Total savings & investments	
Total debts owed	
Net worth (savings & investments minus debts)	

Bonus: Official Resource Links

Bookmark these official sources directly rather than searching for them each time. This is the single easiest way to avoid landing on a look-alike scam site.

Bank of Ghana

[bog.gov.gh](#): Treasury Bill rates, licensed bank lists, consumer protection.

Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) Ghana

[sec.gov.gh](#): Licensed fund managers, brokers, and dealers, and public warnings about unlicensed entities.

Ghana Stock Exchange

[gse.com.gh](#): Listed companies, share prices, market data.

Databank Group

[databankgroup.com](#): MFUND, BFUND, EPACK and other unit trusts.

IC Wealth (IC Group)

[wealth.ic.africa](#): IC Liquidity Fund, Treasury Bills, and GSE stock trading.

Fido Ghana

[gh.fido.money](#): EasySave digital savings wallet.

Robayer WealthLab

[www.robayerwealthlab.com](#): Free calculators, scam alerts, and future guides.

Glossary

APR (Annual Percentage Rate)

The yearly cost of borrowing, or yearly return on an investment, expressed as a percentage.

Bond

A longer-term loan to a government or company that pays periodic interest, similar in concept to a Treasury Bill but typically longer in duration.

Compounding

Earning returns not just on your original money, but on the returns it has already earned. This is the core engine behind every growth table in this book.

Dividend

A portion of a company's profit paid out directly to its shareholders, usually once or twice a year.

Equity

Another word for a share or stock: ownership in a company.

Inflation

The rate at which prices rise over time, which erodes the purchasing power of money left idle.

Interest

The amount earned (as a saver/lender) or paid (as a borrower) for the use of money over time.

Liquidity

How quickly and easily an investment can be converted back into cash without losing value.

Mutual Fund / Unit Trust

A pooled investment vehicle managed by a licensed professional, where investors buy "units" representing a share of the fund's holdings.

NAV (Net Asset Value)

The per-unit value of a mutual fund, calculated by dividing the total value of its holdings by the number of units outstanding.

SEC (Securities and Exchange Commission)

Ghana's regulator for fund managers, brokers, and dealers in the capital markets.

Susu

Ghana's traditional system of regular small savings contributions, now available in both informal and regulated digital forms.

Treasury Bill (T-Bill)

A short-term, government-backed debt instrument sold at a discount and repaid at face value at maturity.

Yield

The income return on an investment, typically expressed as an annual percentage of the amount invested.

Appendix: Side-by-Side Comparison

OPTION	MIN. TO START	RISK	TYPICAL RETURN	ACCESS TO CASH
Digital Savings Wallet (e.g. EasySave)	GH¢1–20	Very Low	~10%/yr	Instant
MTN Pesewa Susu	GH¢1	Very Low	Variable, modest	Instant
Treasury Bills	GH¢100–500	Very Low	~24–30%/yr*	At maturity
Money Market / Mutual Funds	GH¢1–500	Low	~15–25%/yr*	~1 business day
IC Wealth Platform (licensed)	GH¢1	Low–Medium	Varies by product	Per product
Bank Fixed Deposit	GH¢500–1,000	Very Low	~15–20%/yr (pre-tax)*	At maturity
GSE Stocks	GH¢50–100	Higher (short-term)	Variable, not guaranteed	1–3 business days
Petty Trading / Skills	GH¢50–500	Variable	Depends on execution	Ongoing

**Rates marked with an asterisk move regularly, always confirm the current published rate before investing. All figures reflect information available as of mid-2026 and are illustrative, not guaranteed.*

Continue Your Wealth Journey

Financial breakthroughs in Ghana rarely arrive as a single lucky win. They come from small, boring, repeated decisions: a susu deduction you barely notice, a T-Bill rolled over instead of spent, a scam ad you scrolled past because you knew better. Everything in this book is designed to help you make those decisions, starting today, with whatever you have, even if that's just GH¢1.

JOIN THE ROBAYER WEALTHLAB COMMUNITY

Visit www.robayerwealthlab.com and sign up to receive:

- Weekly investment tips
- Scam alerts as new schemes are identified
- Free calculators and spreadsheets
- New eBooks as they're released
- Curated investment opportunities

Other Books by Robayer WealthLab

COMING SOON

- The Ghana Investment Handbook
- The Beginner's Treasury Bill Guide
- The Smart Budget Blueprint
- Money Habits of Wealthy Ghanaians
- How to Build Wealth with GH¢10 a Day
- The Ghana Stock Market Handbook